MARKET INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING / OCTOBER 2026

College Jersey Patches in 2026: Deals, Buyers, and the New Commercial Market

The first three months of college jersey patches: who bought, what they paid, and what is still for sale

122 patch partnerships announced by October 30, 2026, at 103 Division I schools and conferences



Prepared by Katherine Rowe
Playbook Strategies | playbookstrategies.co

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COLLEGE ATHLETICS / LAST UPDATED OCTOBER 30, 2026 / PREPARED BY KATHERINE ROWE

College Jersey Patches in 2026: Deals, Buyers, and the New Commercial Market

A new class of inventory, sold in five kinds of package.

1 Executive summary

The commercial question

The NCAA let Division I schools sell up to two commercial logos on uniforms from August 1, 2026. By October 30, 103 schools and the Big 12 had announced 122 patch partnerships. Public prices run from $100,000 for one football season to a reported $18 million to $20 million a year at Notre Dame. Most of the large numbers cover a bigger partnership that includes the patch. So, what did schools sell, who bought it, which prices compare, and how much of the modeled value of Division I uniforms is still unsold?

PATCH PARTNERSHIPS ANNOUNCED

122

December 2025 to October 30, 2026; 32 in October

DIVISION I SCHOOLS WITH A DEAL

103 of 363

28 of 68 Power Four, 33 of 67 Group of Five, 42 of 228 others

MODELED ANNUAL VALUE, ALL PROGRAMS

$512.2M

Mid estimate; range $412.3M to $670.2M

1. **Announcements rose every month from June to October.** Seven deals were announced in June and 32 in October. Twelve of the October deals covered basketball only, signed as the season started. Section 3
2. **Schools sold five different products under one rule.** Of the 122 deals, 38 cover the whole department, 33 a selected group of sports, 26 football only, 23 basketball only, and 2 are conference platforms. Section 4
3. **Finance and healthcare buy the most patches.** Banks, credit unions, insurers, and financial firms hold 35 of the 122 deals and health systems hold 19. Two thirds of the buyers, 84 of 122, already had an athletics or university relationship. Sections 5 and 6
4. **Most published prices describe packages.** Of 23 deals with a public annual figure, 18 are bundled with naming, signage, digital, NIL, or category rights. Four prices cover the patch alone, between $100,000 and $350,000 a year. Section 7
5. **Schools are splitting inventory across buyers.** Tennessee, Florida State, Wisconsin, UConn, UTSA, and Hawaii each sell different sports to different sponsors. Selling by sport leaves room for a second buyer, and each contract then has to spell out categories and exclusivity. Section 8
6. **Nearly half the modeled value sits at Power Four schools that have not sold.** This model puts $419.8M of the $512.2M mid estimate at the 68 Power Four programs, and the 40 without a deal, led by Texas, Penn State, Alabama, and Michigan, hold $249.8M of it. The model puts an athletics wide deal at Texas, the largest open program, at ~$19.7 million a year, just above Ohio State and Notre Dame. Section 9
7. **Most national brands are not in the market yet.** Three in five sponsors are headquartered within 25 miles of campus. Of 73 brands that sponsor the NCAA, the CFP, a bowl, or a Power Four conference, only Monster Energy and ReliaQuest hold a patch. Retail, fintech, and telecom brands hold 19% of US pro patch deals and 2 of the 122 college deals. Section 10

2 Background: the rule that created the patch market

On January 23, 2026, the NCAA Division I Cabinet approved commercial logos on uniforms, equipment, and apparel, effective August 1. Schools can add up to two commercial logos to uniforms and apparel in preseason and regular season competition, and one to equipment. Each logo can be no larger than 4 square inches, and conferences can allow one more logo at conference championships. Patches are not allowed at NCAA championships, so basketball patches come off for March Madness.

Figure 1. Where a commercial patch can appear in 2026-27 REPORTED

	Preseason and regular season	Conference championships	College Football Playoff	NCAA championships
Uniforms and apparel	Up to 2 added logos	1 further logo allowed	Outside NCAA championship rule	Not allowed
Equipment	1 added logo	Follows conference policy	Outside NCAA championship rule	Not allowed

4 sq in
Maximum size per logo

Source: NCAA, January 23, 2026; CBS Sports and Morgan Lewis summaries of the rule.

Why the money matters now

The College Sports Commission set the 2026-27 revenue sharing cap at $21.58 million per school. The reported $18 million to $20 million a year at Notre Dame is close to that figure in size.

Scope

Division I uniform patch partnerships announced through October 30, 2026, from the Playbook College Commercial Rights database, and the Playbook D1 Programs valuation model of every Division I athletic department.

3 Market snapshot and deal flow

The database tracks 122 patch partnerships at 105 rights holders: 103 Division I schools, the Big 12, and Ferris State. Fifteen of them hold more than one patch deal.

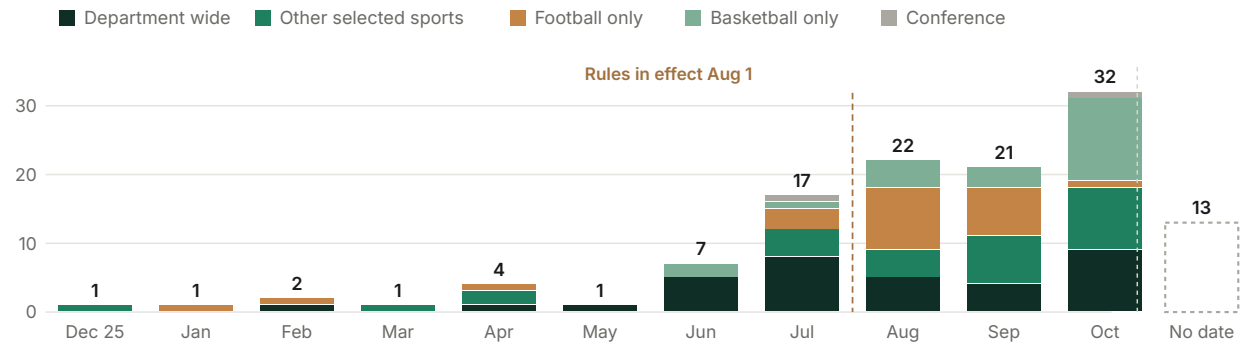
PATCH PARTNERSHIPS
122
at 105 rights holders

SCHOOLS WITH A DEAL
103
of 363 Division I schools

PUBLIC ANNUAL FIGURE
23
deals; 18 of them bundled packages

PROGRAMS VALUED
360
in the Playbook D1 model

Figure 2. Patch deals by announcement month, colored by what the deal covers PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENTS



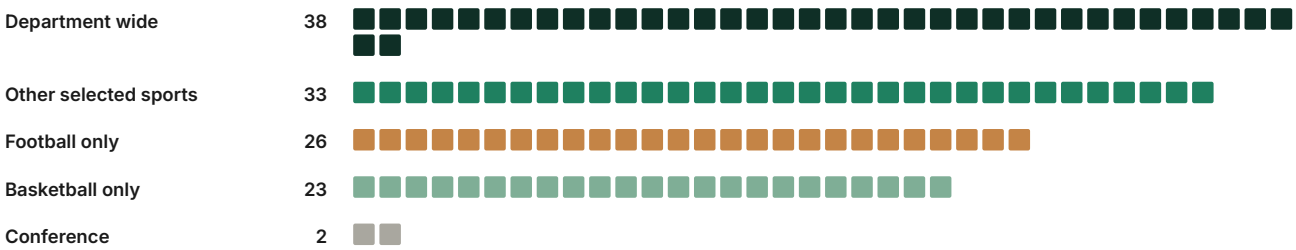
June brought 7 announcements, July had 17, August with 22, September at 21, and October closing at 32. Basketball drove October: 12 of the 32 deals cover basketball only, compared with 10 in all earlier months combined. The first schools to sign announced before the rule took effect, led by UNLV in December 2025 and Louisiana-Monroe, New Mexico State, and Wyoming in the spring.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, October 30, 2026.

4 What schools sold: five packages

Every deal uses the same 4 square inch logo. The deals differ in which uniforms carry it, so we've grouped them by sport.

Figure 3. The 122 deals by what the patch covers, one square per deal, in announcement order ANALYSIS



Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Department wide includes deals covering every varsity program. Other selected sports covers any multisport set short of the whole department, plus single sports other than football and basketball.

PACKAGE	WHAT THE SPONSOR BUYS	EXAMPLES	PRICING CONSEQUENCE
Department wide (38)	One logo across every team, all year	Ohio State / JPMorganChase; Notre Dame / SoFi; SMU / Texas Capital; Indiana / Merchants Bank	The buyer pays for Olympic sports along with football and basketball; the school has no patch left to sell
Other selected sports (33)	A chosen set of sports	Tennessee / First Horizon; Illinois / Busey; Wisconsin / UW Health	Leaves sports open for other buyers; needs a list of who owns which uniform
Football only (26)	The highest reach sport	Pitt / UPMC; Texas Tech / State Farm; Utah / University of Utah Health	Price follows football audience; basketball stays open
Basketball only (23)	Men's or women's basketball, or both	Arizona / Carvana; Tennessee / Axle; UConn / UConn Health	Regular season only; the patch comes off for the NCAA tournament
Conference (2)	One logo on every member's uniforms	Big 12 / Monster Energy; Big 12 / Principal (championships)	The fee cannot be divided by members to price a school patch

5 Five commercial approaches

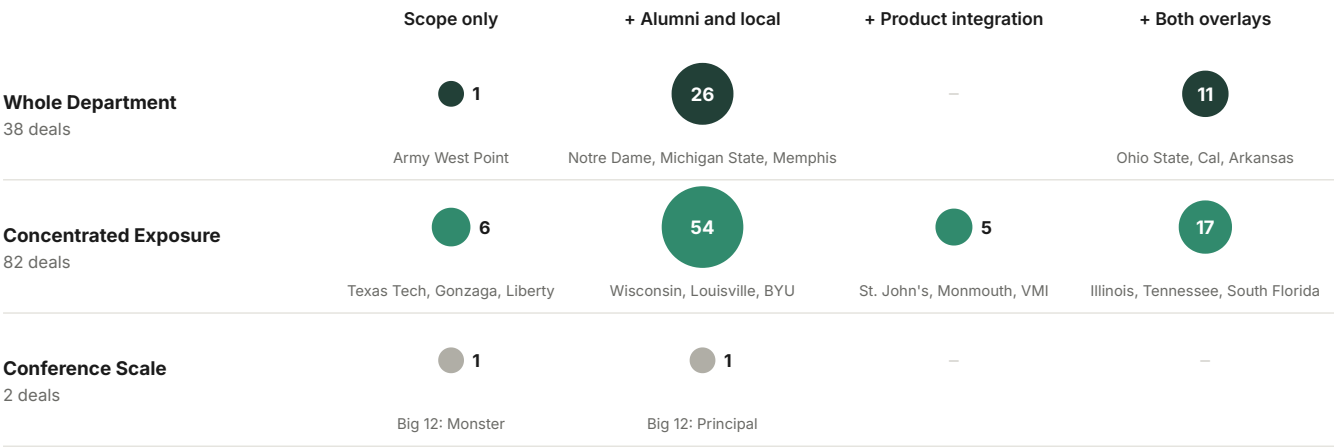
The reported deals already take several commercial shapes, and a benchmark drawn from Notre Dame or Ohio State only applies to a similarly structured deal. We've set out five approaches: three describe the scope of what is sold, and two describe why a particular sponsor wants it.

APPROACH	DEALS	WHAT THE SPONSOR BUYS	EXAMPLES
Whole Department	38	One partner across every program and, in the largest deals, the wider university: students, athletes, alumni, fans, and venues. The patch is the most visible part of a bigger relationship.	Notre Dame / SoFi: all 26 programs, financial education, career development, a student athlete fund, and walk on scholarships. Ohio State / JPMorganChase: all 36 programs, venue branding, the 1922 Club, cardholder benefits, and NIL.
Concentrated Exposure	82	Specific sports chosen for the audience they reach. Each sport reaches a different audience: a patch on a football shoulder, a basketball chest, a hockey sweater, a golf polo, or a baseball jersey is seen by different people.	BYU / Entrata on football; Illinois / Busey across nine sports; Wisconsin / Culver's on football, men's basketball, and men's hockey.
Conference Scale	2	A conference entitlement across every member, with cobranded patches, field and court logos, conference digital assets, and title rights.	Big 12 / Monster Energy on regular season football and basketball, reported at about $20 million a year; Big 12 / Principal at conference championships.
Product Integration	33	A sponsor whose product the department or its fans use, so the deal shows the product in use as well as the logo.	Cal / Dialpad: all 30 sports, with Dialpad as the official AI platform for fan experience across ticketing, service, partnerships, fundraising, and operations.
Alumni and Local Alignment	109	A sponsor already tied to the school's community through customers, employees, operations, or personal history.	Michigan State / MSUFCU share an institutional history. Arkansas / Tyson Foods covers all 19 teams and makes Tyson the official protein. Ripple CEO Brad Garlinghouse is a Kansas alumnus and former student body president, and SoFi CEO Anthony Noto's daughter is a recent Notre Dame graduate who played four years of lacrosse there.

Deal counts across all 122 partnerships. Each deal carries one scope approach; Product Integration and Alumni and Local Alignment can be added to any of them. Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026; school and sponsor announcements.

The approaches overlap. A whole department package can also be locally aligned, and a product integration can cover every sport. Cal's Dialpad deal is both: the product runs through the department's operations, and Dialpad founder and CEO Craig Walker is a Cal alumnus. Dialpad gets awareness, a product demonstration, and customer validation; Cal gets sponsorship revenue and a technology partner that supports the department.

Figure 4. How the approaches combine across the 122 deals ANALYSIS



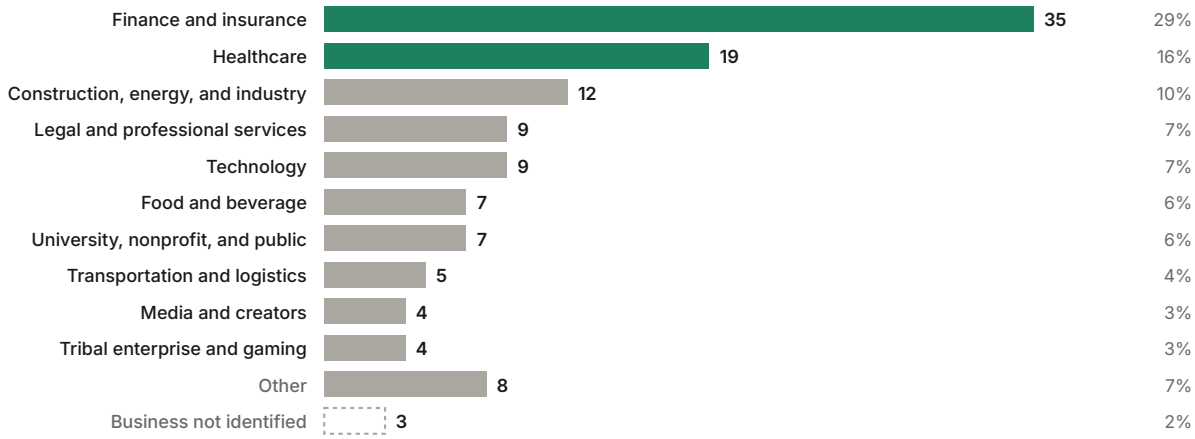
Most deals combine a scope approach with alumni or local alignment: 71 of the 82 concentrated deals and 37 of the 38 whole department deals have some elements. Only eight deals carry no overlay, among them Texas Tech / State Farm and Gonzaga / Altana. Concentrated Exposure is the most common scope because it keeps inventory open: a school can sell football to one partner, group Olympic sports for another, or build several focused relationships instead of one department wide package.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Circle size shows the number of deals.

6 Who is buying

Finance and healthcare lead the buyer list. Banks and credit unions can use a campus deal to win student accounts, alumni deposits, and wealth clients; health systems use it alongside care delivery, workforce recruiting, and community programs. The deal terms suggest these reasons, but the public prices do not show either category paying more.

Figure 5. Sponsor business category, all 122 deals ANALYSIS



Finance and insurance holds 35 deals, 29% of the total, and healthcare 19, or 16%. Banks and credit unions alone hold 23 deals, from JPMorganChase at Ohio State to credit unions at Buffalo, UAlbany, Siena, and East Tennessee State.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Other covers automotive, marketplace, retail, senior living, and agriculture.

MEN'S BASKETBALL PATCHES

79

deals that put a patch on men's basketball

WOMEN'S BASKETBALL PATCHES

70

deals that put a patch on women's basketball

WOMEN'S SPORTS LED DEALS

6

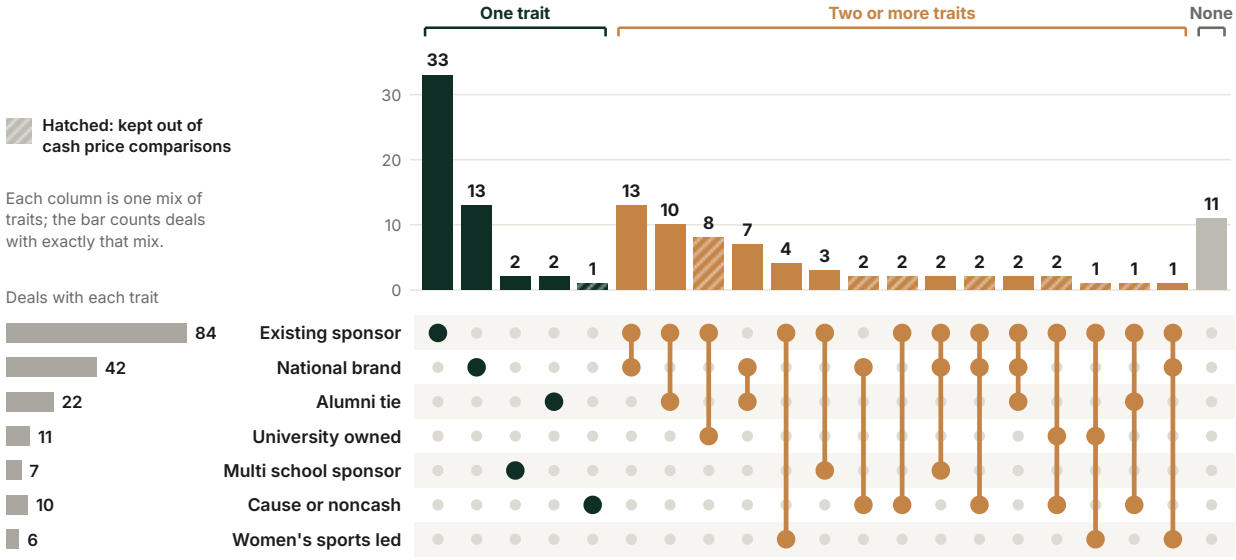
UW Health at Wisconsin, Aetna at UConn, and four smaller deals

Deal traits that overlap

Seven traits cut across the categories and approaches. The sponsor:

- Already worked with the school
- Is a national brand
- Has an alumnus or a leader's family tied to the school
- Is owned by the university
- Holds patches at more than one school
- Pays partly in cause, content, or media
- Built the deal around women's sports

Figure 6. Deal traits and how they combine, all 122 deals ANALYSIS



- **Existing sponsor, 84 deals.** The largest group, and most deals with two or more traits include it. For each one, the question is how much of the fee is new money.
- **University owned, 11 deals.** Pitt / UPMC, Utah / University of Utah Health, and UConn / UConn Health. These have no outside market price, so they are hatched and kept out of price comparisons.
- **Alumni or family tie, 22 deals.** SoFi CEO Anthony Noto's daughter played four years of lacrosse at Notre Dame; Dialpad founder Craig Walker is a Cal graduate; Ripple CEO Brad Garlinghouse is a Kansas graduate. Nine of the 22 are national brands; the rest are regional firms led by alumni, such as Centennial Bank at Arkansas State.
- **Three traits.** USAA is an existing military partner, a national brand, and a sponsor at both Army and Air Force. Aetna at UConn combines an existing relationship, a national brand, and a women's sports platform.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. National brand, university owned, and cause or noncash are classified from each sponsor's identity.

Five buyer types

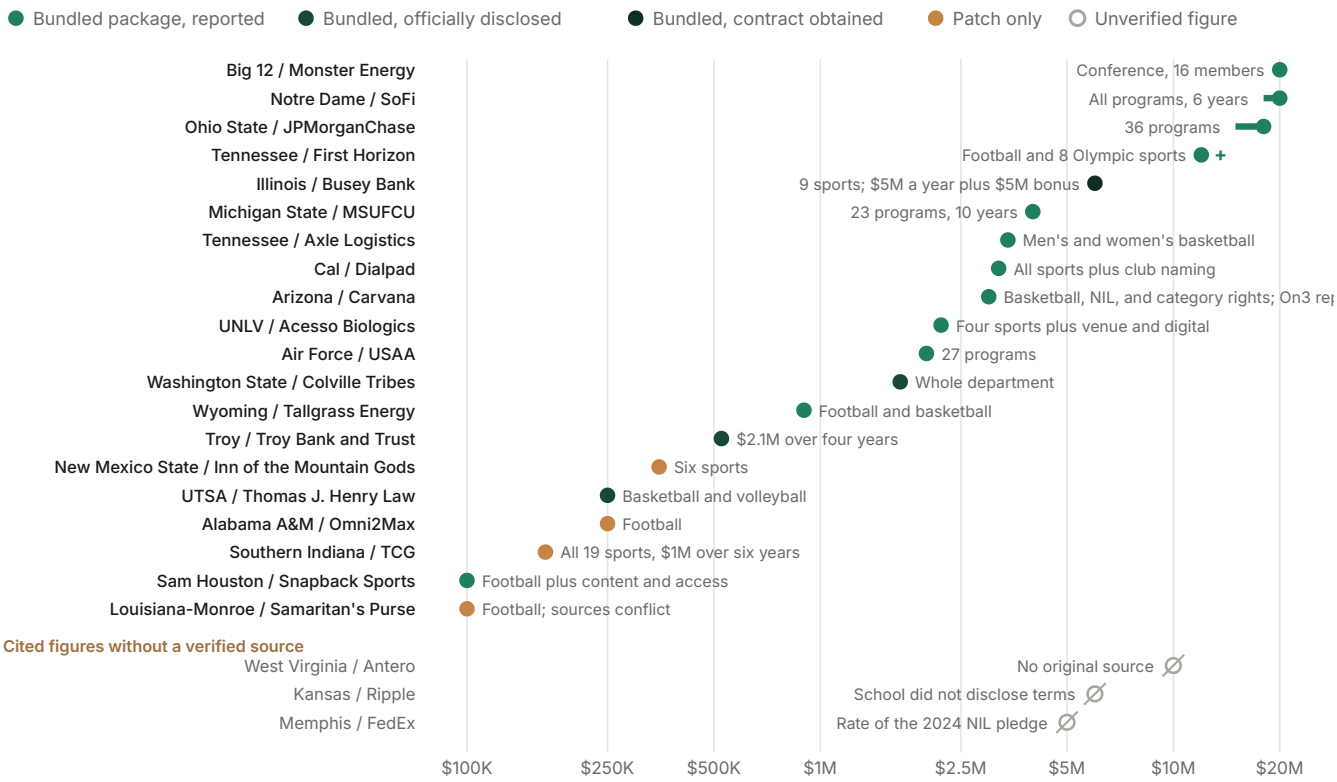
BUYER	EXAMPLES	WHAT THE BUYER GETS BEYOND EXPOSURE	METRIC TO VERIFY RETURN
Regional bank or credit union	Merchants Bank (Indiana), Texas Capital (SMU), Busey (Illinois), MSUFCU (Michigan State), Broadview FCU (Buffalo, UAlbany, Siena)	Accounts, deposits, wealth clients, local credibility, financial education programs	Accounts opened, deposits, cost per acquired customer
National financial brand	SoFi (Notre Dame), JPMorganChase (Ohio State), USAA (Air Force, Army)	National alumni reach, broadcast association, NIL programs	Incremental reach, recall, product signups by market
Health system	UW Health, UConn Health, UPMC, Premier Health, Renown Health, Tampa General	Patient awareness, physician and nurse recruiting, community programs	Program participation, recruiting response, referral volume
Regional employer or industry	Tallgrass Energy (Wyoming), Antero (West Virginia), TCG (Southern Indiana), Steamfitters Local 420 (Drexel)	Workforce pipeline, research ties, alumni managers	Internships, applications, hires
Media or noncash partner	Snapback Sports (Sam Houston), All Hail (Robert Morris)	Content and distribution in place of, or alongside, cash	Views and engagement; excluded from cash price comparisons

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026; school and sponsor announcements.

7 Public price signals: what can be compared

Twenty three deals have a reported or estimated annual figure. Most describe a package of rights in which the patch is one item, and only four price the patch alone.

Figure 7. Annual partnership values associated with patch rights, log scale REPORTED



The figures run from $100,000 for one football season at Louisiana-Monroe to $20 million a year for the Big 12 platform.

Source: School and sponsor announcements; Front Office Sports; ESPN; On3; Sports Business Journal; Illinois / Busey contract obtained by Front Office Sports. Ranges show the reported range; a plus sign marks a reported floor.

Patch only benchmarks

SCHOOL / SPONSOR	ANNUAL VALUE	SCOPE	EVIDENCE
New Mexico State / Inn of the Mountain Gods	$350K	Six sports, three years, exclusive	Reported amount; school confirms scope and term
Alabama A&M / Omni2Max	$250K	Football	Reported amount
Southern Indiana / TCG	$166.7K	All 19 sports	Officially $1M over six years
Louisiana-Monroe / Samaritan's Purse	About $100K	Football, one season	Sources differ on the amount
Stony Brook / Bulovas Restorations	Range only	Eight sports, three years	"High six figures" in total

Sam Houston's $100,000 deal with Snapback Sports also buys at least 50 pieces of content and team access, so it counts as a bundled deal.

8 How schools divide inventory

Fifteen rights holders have more than one patch deal. Most split the inventory by sport, so each buyer gets a different sport.

Figure 8. Patch sponsors by sport at ten schools with more than one patch partner PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENTS

	Football	Men's basketball	Women's basketball	Other sports
Tennessee	First Horizon	Axle Logistics	Axle Logistics	First Horizon (8 sports)
Florida State	Kin Insurance	ReliaQuest	Kin Insurance	Kin Insurance (16 more)
Wisconsin	Culver's	Culver's	UW Health	Culver's (men's hockey) UW Health (3 women's)
UConn	Open	UConn Health	UConn Health	Aetna (11 women's Olympic)
Arizona	+ Monster Energy (Big 12)	Carvana + Monster Energy (Big 12)	Carvana + Monster Energy (Big 12)	Open
BYU	Entrata + Monster Energy (Big 12)	+ Monster Energy (Big 12)	+ Monster Energy (Big 12)	BYU Continuing Ed (6)
UTSA	La Panadería	Thomas J. Henry	Thomas J. Henry	Thomas J. Henry (VB) Las Palapas (W soccer)
Hawaii	Hawaiian Airlines	First Hawaiian Bank	Shaheen & Gordon	First Hawaiian (W volleyball)
Duquesne	SteelPoint Capital	Gecko Robotics	Open	Open
Omaha	Open	MCL Construction	Open	Hurrdat (W volleyball)

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026; school announcements. Each color is one sponsor within a row. Big 12 members also carry the conference Monster Energy logo on football and basketball.

Tennessee

First Horizon holds football and eight Olympic sports under a 10 year deal reported at more than $120 million, and Axle Logistics holds both basketball programs. Each sponsor needs a written list of the uniforms it owns and the categories it excludes.

Florida State

Kin Insurance covers football and 16 more programs on a four year deal; ReliaQuest, which already worked with the athletics department, the business school, and the ACC, holds men's basketball. Kin sells home insurance in Florida, so its audience is Florida homeowners.

Wisconsin and UConn

Wisconsin gives Culver's football, men's basketball, and men's hockey, and gives UW Health women's basketball, volleyball, women's hockey, and softball. UConn gives UConn Health both basketball programs and Aetna 11 women's Olympic sports. Both schools sold women's sports as a separate deal.

Arizona and BYU in the Big 12

The Big 12's Monster Energy deal, reported at $20 million a year, puts a cobranded logo on members' football and basketball uniforms. Arizona then sold Carvana its basketball patch on October 30, and BYU sold football to Entrata and six Olympic sports to BYU Continuing Education. Each Big 12 school has one patch spot left after the conference logo, and Monster's beverage exclusivity limits who can buy it.

Hawaii and UTSA

Hawaii has three sponsors: Hawaiian Airlines on football, First Hawaiian Bank on men's basketball and women's volleyball, and Shaheen & Gordon on women's basketball. UTSA has three as well, all San Antonio businesses, across football, basketball, volleyball, and women's soccer.

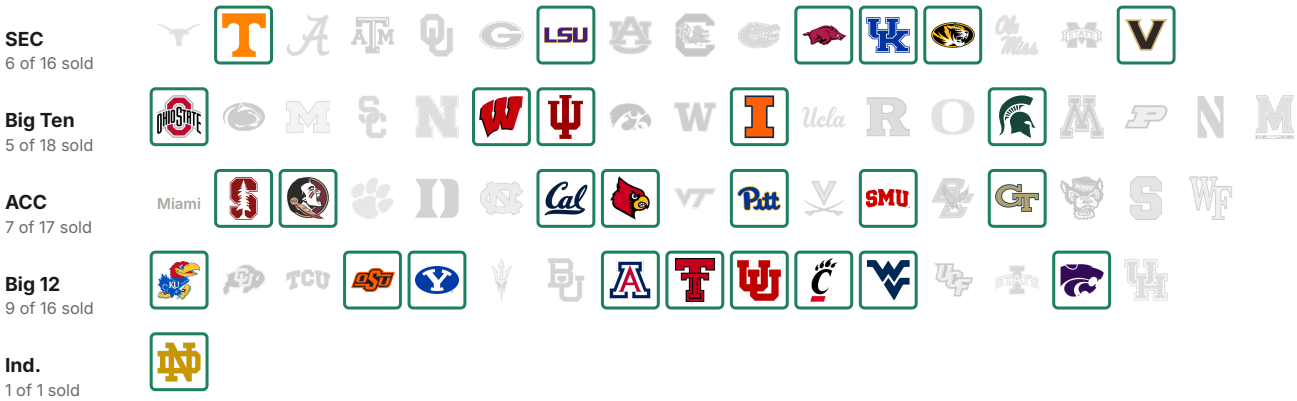
Indiana and SMU

Both sold the whole department to a bank that already sponsored the athletics department: Merchants Bank had field naming at Indiana and Texas Capital had the end zones at SMU. Neither announcement separates the new patch money from the earlier deal.

9 Where the modeled value sits

The Playbook D1 Programs model gives every Division I department a low, mid, and high annual value for a department wide patch partnership, based on athletic revenue and fitted to the deals schools have reported. Across 360 valued programs the mid estimates add to $512.2M a year, with a range of $412.3M to $670.2M. That total assumes every school sells at its modeled value, so it shows the size of the market, not a forecast of 2026 revenue. Power Four ranges run from 85% to 120% of the mid; ranges for other schools run wider, from 60% to 180%, because their prices vary more with the sponsor and the package.

Figure 9. Power Four schools with an announced patch deal, by conference ANNOUNCED / MODEL

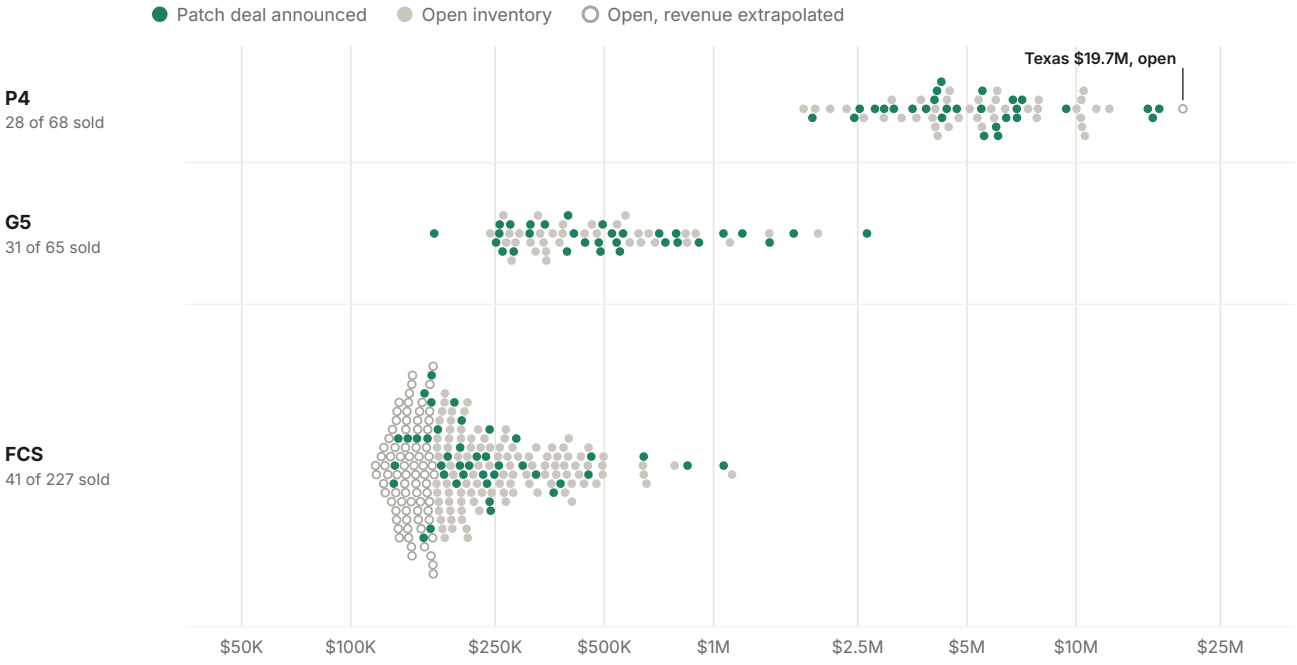


Ordered by modeled value within each conference, highest first. Green border: at least one announced patch deal by Oct 30, 2026.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026; Playbook D1 Programs model.

Twenty eight of the 68 Power Four schools have sold. The SEC has the most unsold value: Texas, Alabama, Texas A&M, Oklahoma, and Georgia are all open, and each models above $10 million. Texas models at $19.7 million, just above Ohio State at $17.0 million and Notre Dame at $16.3 million; those two and Tennessee, the next three highest valued programs, sold early.

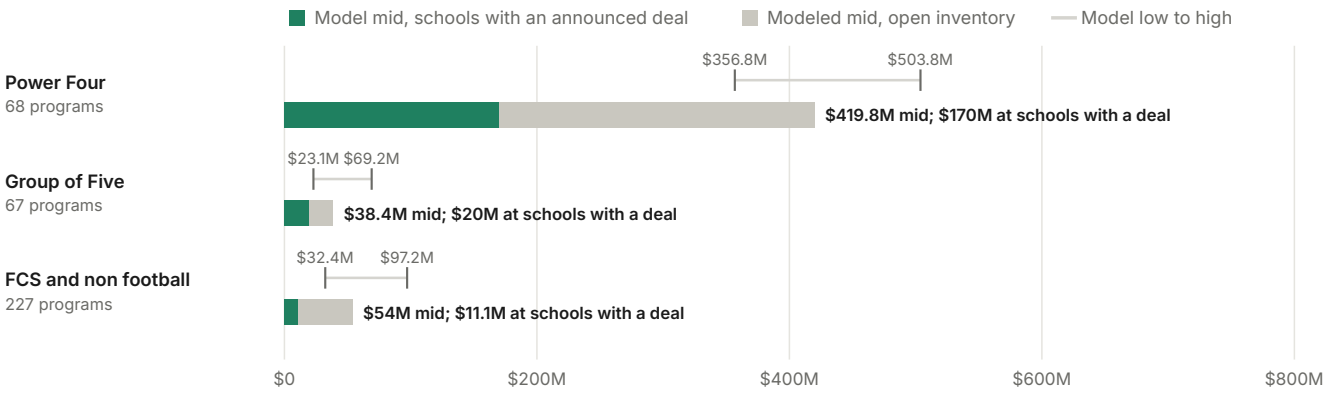
Figure 10. Modeled mid value for every Division I program, by tier, log scale MODEL



The tiers barely overlap. The median Power Four program models at $5.4 million, the median Group of Five program at $442,000 and the median FCS or non football program at $188,000. Schools with deals appear across each tier, so a school does not need top revenue to find a buyer.

Source: Playbook D1 Programs model; Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Air Force and Army have no revenue input and are left out. Open circles mark open programs whose revenue the model extrapolated.

Figure 11. Modeled annual value by tier, split by whether the school has sold MODEL



Power Four programs hold $419.8M of the $512.2M mid total, or 82%. Schools that have announced a deal account for $201M, or 39% of modeled value. The open Power Four schools hold $249.8M.

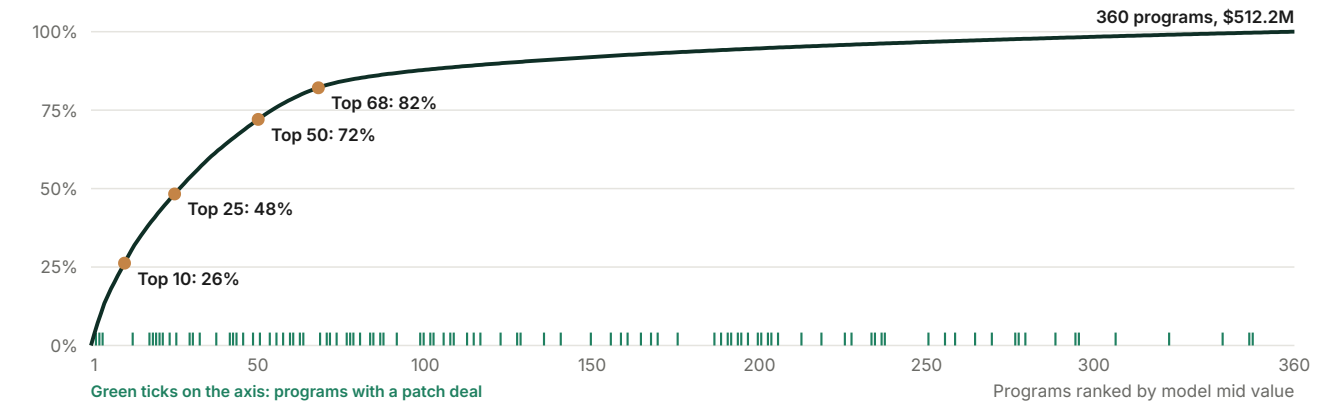
Source: Playbook D1 Programs model; deal status as of October 30, 2026.

The ten open Power Four programs with the highest modeled value

SCHOOL	CONFERENCE	ATHLETIC REVENUE FY25	MODELED RANGE	MODELED MID
Texas	SEC	$343.1M	$16.8M to $23.7M	**$19.7M**
Penn State	Big Ten	$254.4M	$10.5M to $14.8M	**$12.4M**
Alabama	SEC	$244.6M	$9.7M to $13.6M	**$11.4M**
Michigan	Big Ten	$236.4M	$9M to $12.7M	**$10.6M**
Texas A&M	SEC	$235.5M	$8.9M to $12.6M	**$10.5M**
Oklahoma	SEC	$234.4M	$8.8M to $12.5M	**$10.4M**
USC	Big Ten	$234M	$8.8M to $12.4M	**$10.4M**
Georgia	SEC	$233.5M	$8.8M to $12.4M	**$10.3M**
Miami	ACC	$230.5M	$8.5M to $12M	**$10M**
Nebraska	Big Ten	$205.8M	$6.7M to $9.5M	**$7.9M**

Source: Playbook D1 Programs model; EADA FY2024-25 revenue. Texas revenue is extrapolated in the model input.

Figure 12. Cumulative share of modeled value, programs ranked from highest to lowest MODEL

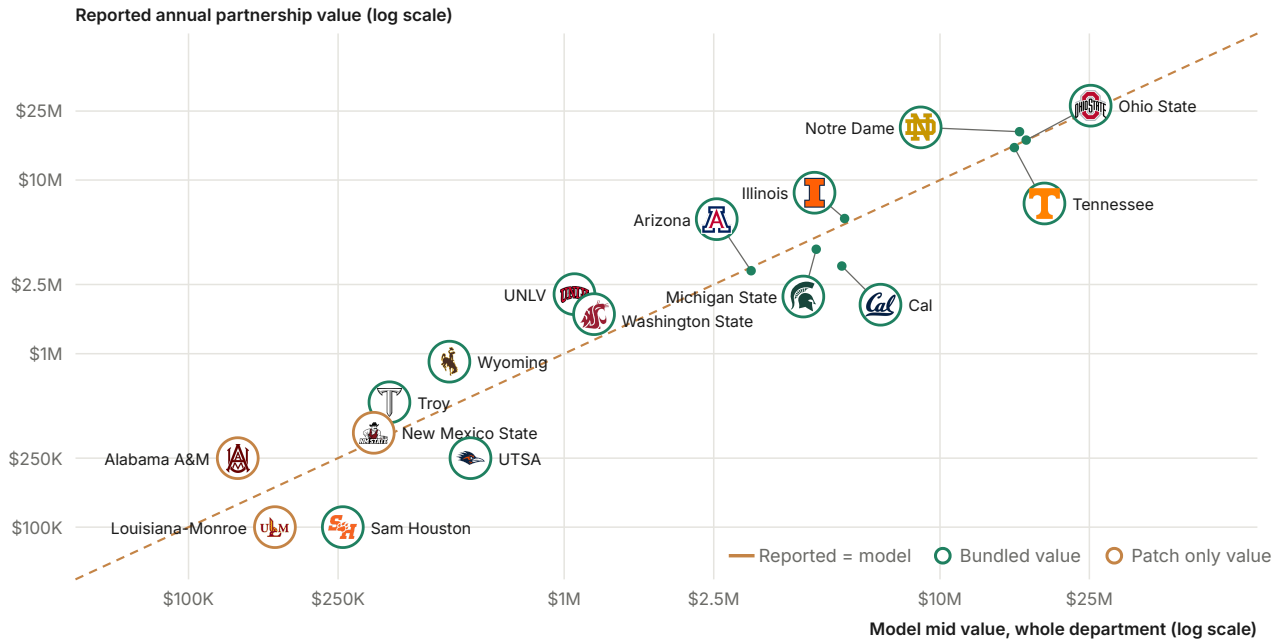


The ten highest valued programs hold 26% of modeled value, the top 25 hold 48%, and the top 50 hold 72%. A sponsor or a seller studying the market can cover most of its value by watching about 50 schools.

Source: Playbook D1 Programs model.

How reported deals compare with the model

Figure 13. Reported annual value against modeled mid, by school REPORTED / MODEL



The 16 schools with a reported annual value sit around the line: Ohio State reports its modeled value almost exactly, Notre Dame sits 17% above, and Tennessee, with its two deals combined, 2% below. Wyoming, UNLV, Alabama A&M, and Troy report well above their modeled value; the Wyoming and UNLV packages include venue, digital, or industry rights along with the patch. Cal, UTSA, and Sam Houston report less; Cal includes club naming and Sam Houston was paid partly in content.

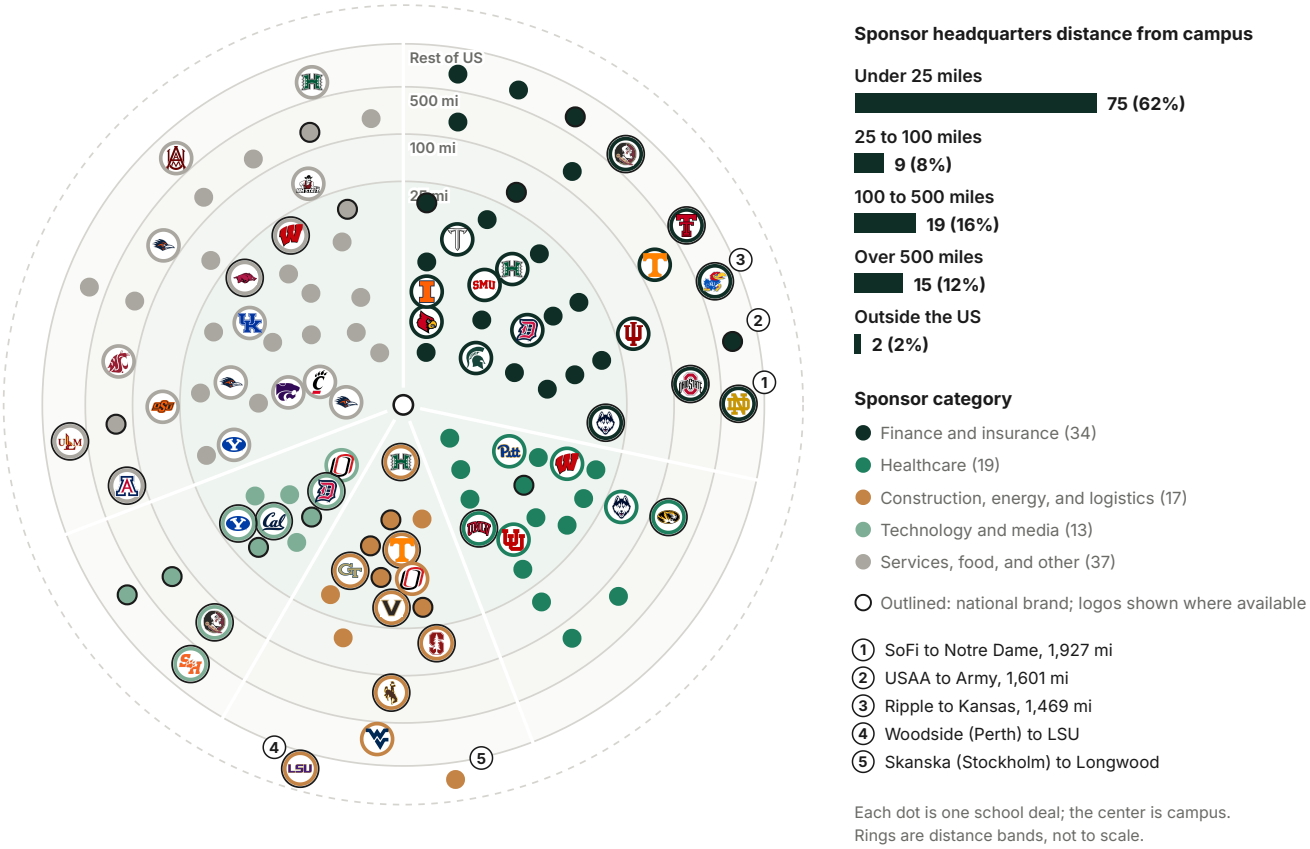
Source: Playbook D1 Programs model; reported values from Section 7. Tennessee combines First Horizon and Axle Logistics.

10 Whitespace: brands not yet in the market

Most of the brands that already spend on college sports have not bought a patch. Of 73 national brands that sponsor the NCAA, the College Football Playoff, a bowl game, or a Power Four conference, two hold a school or conference patch: Monster Energy with the Big 12 and ReliaQuest at Florida State. Of 153 companies with a patch in the NBA, WNBA, NHL, MLB, MLS, or NWSL, five also hold a college patch: JPMorganChase (Ohio State), Vanda Pharmaceuticals (George Washington), Yale New Haven Health (Fairfield), Carvana (Arizona), and DoorDash (Stanford).

Today's buyers are local

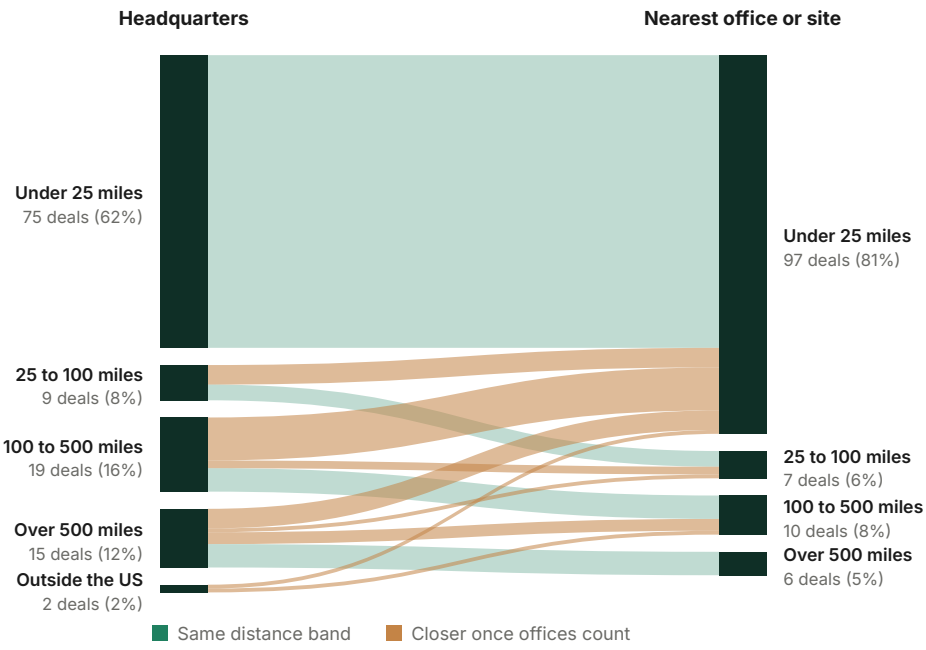
Figure 14. Where patch sponsors are headquartered, by distance from campus ANALYSIS



Three in five sponsors are headquartered within 25 miles of campus, and 70% within 100 miles; the median distance is 12 miles. Half of the national brand deals, 20 of 40, are hometown companies: FedEx at Memphis, Tyson Foods at Arkansas, Dialpad at Cal, Entrata at BYU, Culver's at Wisconsin, and Axle Logistics at Tennessee. Only 17 deals come from a sponsor based more than 500 miles away, and four of those have a large operation near campus, such as USAA near the Air Force Academy and Antero in West Virginia.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Headquarters from company sites, filings, and announcements; distance is straight line from the main campus to the headquarters city. The two Big 12 conference deals are not shown.

Figure 15. Sponsor distance from campus: headquarters against nearest office or site ANALYSIS

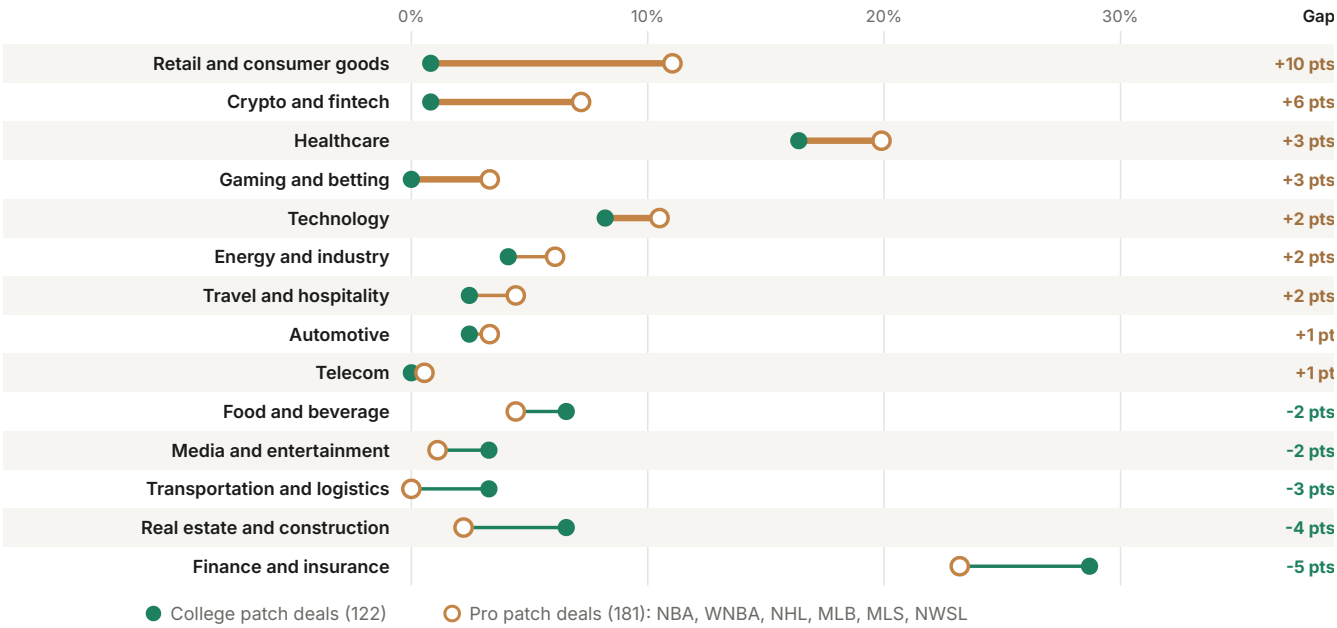


Counting the nearest staffed office, branch, hospital, plant, or project site, 97 of the 120 sponsors (81%) operate within 25 miles of campus. JPMorganChase has a large operations campus in Columbus, USAA has offices near Army and Air Force, State Farm has agents in Lubbock, and First Horizon has branches in Knoxville. Six deals stay more than 500 miles away, among them SoFi at Notre Dame, Snapback Sports at Sam Houston, and GoH2O at VMI.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Nearest locations from company location pages, filings, and announcements; straight line distance from the main campus.

Brands not yet in the market

Figure 16. Share of patch deals by sponsor category, college against US pro leagues ANALYSIS



Retail, crypto and fintech, and telecom brands hold 19% of pro patch deals and 2 of the 122 college deals: Palmetto State Armory at The Citadel and Ripple at Kansas. Technology, energy, travel, and automotive also have a smaller share in college than in pro sports. College deals have more finance, local construction and services, and university or nonprofit sponsors, which pro teams rarely carry.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026; pro league patch and front of shirt sponsors for the 2026 or 2026-27 season from league and team announcements, Sportico, SportsLogos, and Blinkfire. Other is not shown: 20 college deals, 5 pro deals.

Figure 17. Brands not yet in the college patch market, by category ANALYSIS

CATEGORY	SPONSOR COLLEGE SPORTS NATIONALLY, NO SCHOOL PATCH	BUY PRO PATCHES, NO COLLEGE PATCH
Food and beverage	Coca-Cola, Dr Pepper, Gatorade, Chick-fil-A, Wendy's, Pizza Hut, Subway, Buffalo Wild Wings, Reese's, Sonic	LaCroix, Tillamook, Herbalife
Finance and insurance	Capital One, Allstate, Discover, Prudential, TIAA, T. Rowe Price, Edward Jones, Regions Bank, Invesco	Ally, Stifel, Bank of America, Nationwide, American Family
Technology	Apple, Samsung Galaxy, LG, Intuit TurboTax, TaxSlayer, IFS, Wasabi	Motorola, IREN, Rapid7, Ibotta
Telecom	AT&T, T-Mobile, Cricket Wireless	Telus, in Canada only
Retail and consumer goods	The Home Depot, Unilever, Academy Sports + Outdoors, Sprouts Farmers Market	Kroger, Meijer, Uline, Love's, StockX
Travel and hospitality	Marriott Bonvoy, Hilton, Southwest Airlines, Vrbo	Royal Caribbean, Walt Disney World, Visit Las Vegas
Automotive	Genesis, Goodyear, AutoZone	Toyota, CarMax, AutoNation
Energy and industry	Phillips 66, Valero, Marathon, Lockheed Martin	Nucor, Bloom Energy, Oxy, Cleveland-Cliffs
Crypto and fintech	None at national level; Ripple holds a school patch at Kansas	Albert, Robinhood, Paze, Chime, Webull
Healthcare	*None at national level*	CVS Health, Kaiser Permanente, Independence Blue Cross, Sutter Health

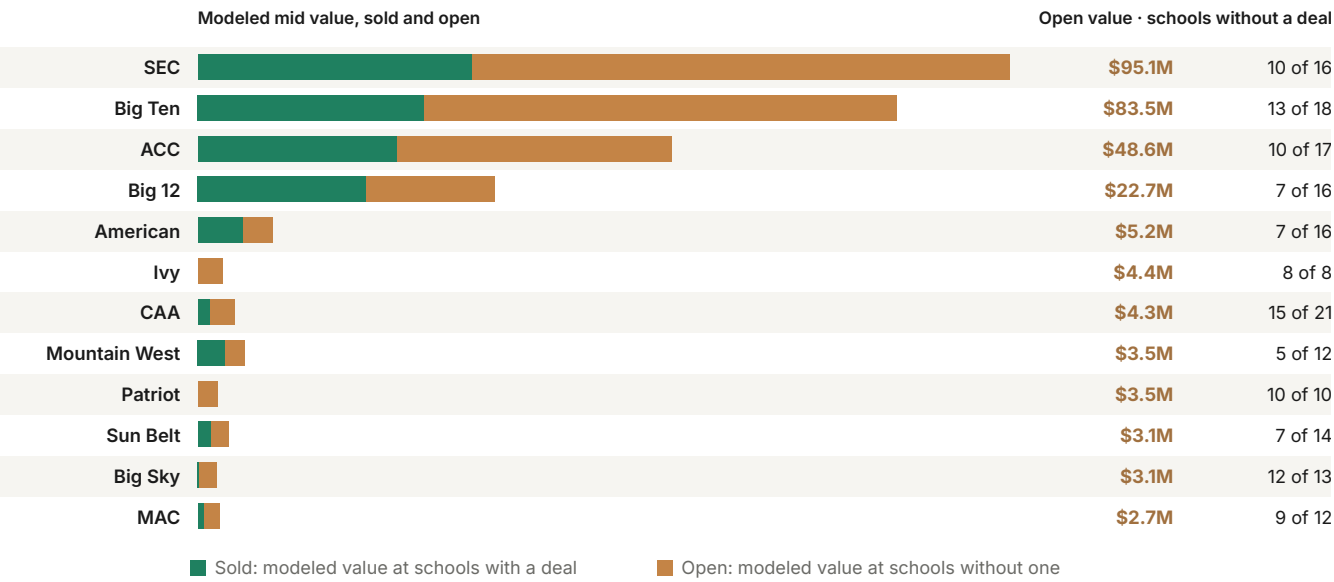
Source: NCAA corporate champions and partners; College Football Playoff and bowl sponsors; SEC, Big Ten, ACC, and Big 12 official partners and championship sponsors; pro league patch sponsors as in Figure 16. Lists show examples, not every brand.

Two limits apply. Sportsbooks hold six pro patches, but the American Gaming Association's marketing code bars its members from college partnerships that promote wagering, and the NCAA bans sports betting and prediction markets at its own championships. Existing contracts also matter: a school with a pouring rights deal or a multimedia rights holder with category exclusivity has to approve a new brand before it can go on the jersey.

Where the open inventory sits

Plenty of inventory is still open for them. The 260 schools without a deal hold $311.2M of modeled mid value a year, and the schools that have sold still have open sports.

Figure 18. Modeled value sold and open, by conference, the 12 largest by open value MODEL

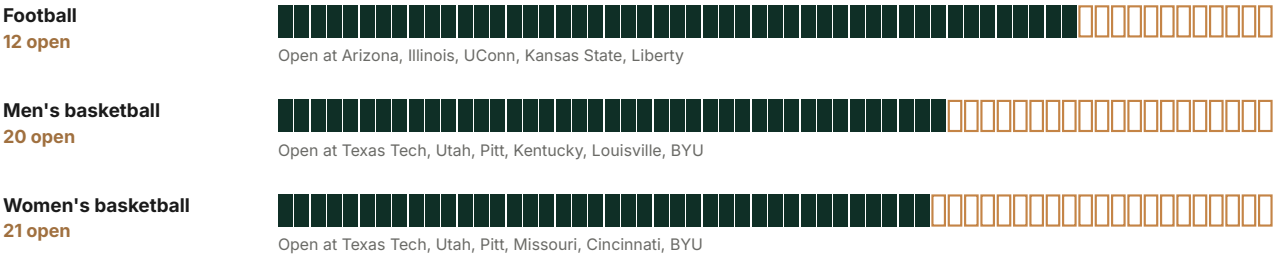


The SEC, Big Ten, ACC, and Big 12 hold $249.8M of open value. The SEC has $95.1M open across 10 schools and the Big Ten $83.5M across 13. Below the Power Four, the Ivy, Patriot, Pioneer, and Big West conferences have no deal at any of their 35 schools.

Source: Playbook D1 Programs model; Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, October 30, 2026.

Figure 19. Sports with and without a patch at the 61 FBS schools that have sold ANALYSIS

Each square is one of the 61 FBS schools with a deal; open squares have no patch on that sport



Of the 61 FBS schools with a deal, 49 have a football patch, 41 a men's basketball patch, and 40 a women's basketball patch. Schools that sold football first, such as Texas Tech, Utah, and Pitt, can still sell both basketball programs to a second partner, as Tennessee and Florida State did. Each uniform can also carry a second commercial logo.

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Department wide deals count as covering all three sports.

Where to look first

WHITESPACE	BRANDS OR INVENTORY	FIRST MOVE
National college sponsors	71 brands with NCAA, CFP, bowl, or conference deals and no patch	Start with brands already paying for college rights; a school patch adds a local presence to a national deal
Telecom and national food and beverage	AT&T, T-Mobile, Coca-Cola, Dr Pepper, Chick-fil-A	Check pouring rights and multimedia rights exclusivity first; these categories are often already sold
Retail, grocery, and fintech	Kroger, Meijer, Home Depot, Albert, Robinhood, Paze	Use their pro patch deals as the comparison; only two college deals sit in these categories
Power Four schools without a deal	40 schools, $249.8M modeled mid	Texas, Penn State, Alabama, and Michigan lead the list; pair a national brand with the department or football package

WHITESPACE	BRANDS OR INVENTORY	FIRST MOVE
Basketball at football first schools	20 FBS schools with no men's basketball patch	Sell both basketball programs to a second partner, with category exclusivity written into both contracts

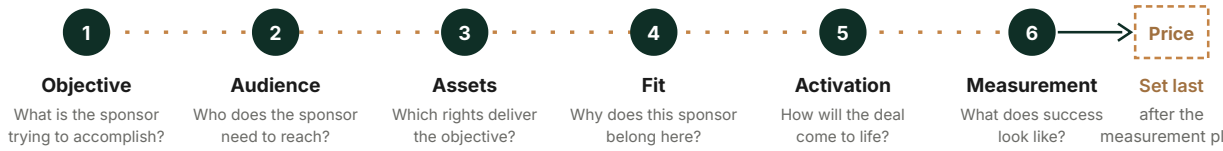
Source: Playbook D1 Programs model; Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026; sponsor lists as in Figure 17.

11 How to build a deal

These structures for a jersey patch partnership can help form the sponsor's strategy and later set the price last, once the measurement plan says what the partnership has to deliver.

Figure 20. Six steps to structure a jersey patch partnership FRAMEWORK

The order to structure a jersey patch partnership, for a school or a sponsor



Source: Katherine Rowe, "Uniformly Different: Approaches to Collegiate Jersey Patches," The Playbook, August 5, 2026.

STEP	WHAT TO SETTLE	WHERE THE 2026 DEALS SHOW IT
1. Objective	National awareness, regional relevance, customer acquisition, recruiting, product adoption, hospitality, or a deeper relationship with a local community. It decides which audiences and assets matter.	JPMorganChase and SoFi bought national financial relationships; Busey, Merchants Bank, and Texas Capital bought regional banking relationships.
2. Audience	College athletics reaches students, alumni, season ticket holders, donors, local families, corporate buyers, recruits, and national viewers, and each group needs different rights.	UW Health and Aetna bought women's sports audiences; Axle Logistics and Carvana bought basketball.
3. Assets	Map the available rights and keep the ones that serve the objective and the audience: the patch, venue, digital, hospitality, NIL, and category rights.	Illinois / Busey sold nine sports plus radio, venue, digital, and hospitality; Tennessee split football and basketball across two buyers.
4. Fit	Alumni overlap, local employment, student relevance, institutional history, geographic footprint, community credibility, and whether the sponsor feels additive or extractive.	109 of the 122 deals show alumni or local alignment, from Tyson Foods at Arkansas to Ripple at Kansas.
5. Activation	Content, fan experiences, hospitality, community programming, and media amplification need their own budget on top of the rights fee.	Notre Dame / SoFi funds financial education, career development, and a student athlete fund alongside the patch.
6. Measurement	Awareness and engagement, leads, acquisition, sales, recruiting, product use, hospitality, or community outcomes, drafted before the price is final.	Few announcements name a measure. Cal / Dialpad comes closest: the product runs through ticketing, service, and fundraising, where use can be counted.

A smaller, focused agreement with a strong activation plan can create more value than a larger package that exists mainly as a logo placement. The projected value needs to connect to the job the partnership is expected to do.

Market check

There may eventually be useful ranges for football only patches, all sports agreements, conference packages, and broad institutional partnerships. Even within those groups, school brand strength, media exposure, sponsor fit, alumni overlap, activation, and the rest of the asset mix will create wide variation. The public deals show where the market may be going, and each partnership still has to be built around a specific sponsor, audience, and objective.

Pricing the package

Once the deal is structured, we've priced it in four layers.

LAYER	QUESTION	INPUTS	STATUS
A. Property value	What is the school worth before any sponsor specific factor?	Athletic revenue, media exposure, attendance, alumni reach, social engagement	Modeled for all Division I programs from reported deals, most of them bundled, so it estimates a partnership with the patch at its center
B. Rights and scope	What exactly is being sold?	Sports, competitions, logo slots, conference logo, exclusivity, term, venue, digital, NIL, hospitality	Recorded per deal; no tested price adjustment yet
C. Sponsor fit	Why would this buyer pay more or less?	Alumni or founder tie, local customers, existing relationship, product use, workforce, mission	No tested price adjustment; explains a price after the fact
D. What the school keeps	How much new cash stays with athletics?	Cash schedule, in kind value, activation cost, rights holder share, prior sponsor spend	Rarely public; the Illinois / Busey contract is the clearest case

For layer D, we use net incremental commercial contribution: annual retained incremental cash plus revenue share received, less direct fulfillment and activation cost. A donor gift, an internal university program, or an NIL commitment does not count as patch revenue under this measure.

12 Commercial priorities

Each priority below starts from a public finding.

PRIORITY	WHAT THE REPORT SUPPORTS	NEXT DECISION AND EVIDENCE
Control of the rights	At least 34 deals name a third party seller, Learfield on 24 of them; Big 12 members also carry a conference logo	Map what the department, conference, university, rights holder, broadcasters, and venue control, with category exclusives and renewal dates, before pricing.
Package design	Five packages in use; Tennessee, Florida State, Wisconsin, and UConn split sports across buyers	Price a whole department offer, a football or basketball offer, and a selected or women's sport offer side by side.
Price range	Four patch only prices under $400,000; most open Power Four schools model between $8 million and $12 million	Start from the modeled range, check the nearest deals by tier, sports, and rights, and leave the patch value blank where only a package price is public.
Buyer list	Finance holds 35 deals, healthcare 19; two thirds of the buyers had an existing relationship	Rank prospects by business case: accounts and deposits, patient and workforce reach, regional customers. Check whether an existing sponsor is adding money or moving it.
Postseason terms	NCAA championships exclude patches "at this time"; the CFP sits outside the NCAA rule	Write approval rights, category protection, payment schedule, and a clause for an NCAA rule change into each contract.
New money	Indiana, SMU, and Memphis built patches into earlier sponsor agreements	Measure retained incremental cash, delivered exposure by competition, and the inventory no longer available to sell.

Recommendation: price the patch against what the school is looking for. A headline package fee includes rights beyond the logo, rights holder economics and, in some deals, money the sponsor already paid. A school, a buyer, or a rights holder needs the retained new cash per season, by sport and logo slot.

For sponsors

OBJECTIVE	WHAT TO BUY	MEASURE
National awareness	A national reach school, its marquee sport, verified broadcast exposure	Incremental reach, recall, viewable impressions
Regional customers	Campus and community access, category rights, local activation, consented fan data	Leads, applications, deposits, cost per acquired customer
Recruiting and workforce	Career programming, athlete and alumni access	Internships, applications, hires
Health and community	A sport platform tied to programs and facilities	Participation and designed impact measures
Content	Athlete NIL and content rights, short form distribution	Completed views, engagement quality, attributable outcomes

13 Signals worth tracking

SIGNAL	WHEN	WHAT IT WOULD TELL YOU
NCAA championship rule	Before March 2027	Whether basketball patches stay on in the NCAA tournament, which changes basketball pricing due to increased media value
Basketball season deals	November 2026	Whether the October run of basketball only deals continues once games start
Open Power Four schools	2026-27 season	Texas models at $19.7 million; Penn State, Alabama, Michigan, Texas A&M, Oklahoma, USC, and Georgia each model above $10 million
Second slots after a conference logo	2026-27 season	How many Big 12 schools sell their remaining slot
Women's sports platforms	2026-27 season	How many sponsors buy women's sports as their main property, as UW Health and Aetna did
First renewals	2027 and later	Whether 2026 prices hold and how many renewals add money over the earlier sponsorship

Takeaway

College jersey patches opened a new market for athletic departments in 2026, and the first season produced a wide spread of prices. Public deals run from local relationships at a few hundred thousand dollars to national packages reported in eight figures, and most of the large ones sell much more than a logo. The value of a school's patch depends on which inventory it sells, why a particular buyer wants it, and how much new revenue the department keeps. Most of the money is in the package around the patch.

Appendix A: All 122 patch partnerships

RIGHTS HOLDER	SPONSOR	CONFERENCE	PACKAGE	SPONSOR CATEGORY	ANNOUNCED	ANNUAL VALUE
Air Force	USAA	Mountain West	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Jun 23	$2M
Alabama A&M	Omni2Max	SWAC	Football only	Legal and professional services		$250K
Alabama at Birmingham	UAB Medicine	American	Basketball only	Healthcare	Oct 12	
App State	Foscoe Companies	Sun Belt	Basketball only	Not identified	Aug 20	
Arizona	Carvana	Big 12	Basketball only	Other	Oct 30	$3M
Arkansas	Tyson Foods	SEC	Department wide	Food and beverage	Jul 1	
Arkansas State	Centennial Bank	Sun Belt	Football only	Finance and insurance	Sep 3	
Army West Point	USAA	Patriot (basketball) / American (football)	Department wide	Finance and insurance		
Austin Peay	Altra Federal Credit Union	UAC	Basketball only	Finance and insurance	Oct 1	
Austin Peay	Mitchell Ross Rocconi	UAC	Football only	Legal and professional services	Aug 25	
BYU	Entrata	Big 12	Football only	Technology	Jul 13	
BYU	BYU Continuing Education	Big 12	Other selected sports	University, nonprofit and public	Jul 27	
Big 12 Conference	Monster Energy	Big 12	Conference	Food and beverage	Jul 7	$20M
Big 12 Conference	Principal Financial Group	Big 12	Conference	Finance and insurance	Oct 15	
Buffalo	Broadview Federal Credit Union	MAC	Basketball only	Finance and insurance	Oct 21	
Cal	Dialpad	ACC	Department wide	Technology	Jul 1	$3.2M
Cincinnati	Jeff Wyler Automotive Family	Big 12	Other selected sports	Other	Aug 31	
DePaul	Desert Cactus	Big East	Basketball only	Other	Jul 16	
Drexel	Steamfitters Local 420	CAA	Basketball only	Construction, energy and industry	Oct 14	
Duquesne	Gecko Robotics	Atlantic 10	Basketball only	Technology	Oct 5	
Duquesne	SteelPoint Capital	NEC	Football only	Finance and insurance	Oct 20	
East Tennessee State	Eastman Credit Union	SoCon	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 22	
East Texas A&M	Alliance Bank	Southland	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 9	
East Texas A&M	Archer Construction & Design	Southland	Football only	Construction, energy and industry	Aug 27	
Elon	Onrise	CAA	Other selected sports	Healthcare	Sep 1	
Fairfield	Yale New Haven Health	Metro Conference (formerly MAAC)	Other selected sports	Healthcare	Oct 1	
Ferris State	Lerner Financial	CCHA	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 7	
Florida International	Miccosukee Casino & Resort	Conference USA	Other selected sports	Tribal enterprise and gaming		
Florida International	PlayerU	Conference USA	Other selected sports	Technology	Sep 18	
Florida State	ReliaQuest	ACC	Basketball only	Technology	Aug 14	
Florida State	Kin Insurance	ACC	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Sep 4	
Fresno State	The Wonderful Company	Pac-12	Department wide	Food and beverage	Aug 7	
George Washington	Vanda Pharmaceuticals	Atlantic 10	Department wide	Healthcare	Jun 22	
Georgia Tech	Veritiv	ACC	Football only	Construction, energy and industry	Sep 1	

RIGHTS HOLDER	SPONSOR	CONFERENCE	PACKAGE	SPONSOR CATEGORY	ANNOUNCED	ANNUAL VALUE
Gonzaga	Altana	Pac-12	Basketball only	Technology	Sep 29	
Hawaii	Hawaiian Airlines	Mountain West	Football only	Transportation and logistics	Aug 25	
Hawaii	First Hawaiian Bank	Mountain West	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Aug 26	
Hawaii	Shaheen & Gordon	Big West	Basketball only	Legal and professional services	Oct 27	
Illinois	Busey Bank	Big Ten	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Jul 27	$6M
Illinois State	Illinois Farm Bureau Family of Companies	Missouri Valley	Department wide	Other	Oct 29	
Incarnate Word	Thomas J. Henry Law	Southland	Basketball only	Legal and professional services	Sep 16	
Indiana	Merchants Bank	Big Ten	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Oct 15	
Kansas	Ripple (XRP)	Big 12	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Jul 8	*Unverified*
Kansas City	JE Dunn Construction	Summit League	Basketball only	Construction, energy and industry	Aug 27	
Kansas State	Purple Wave Auction	Big 12	Football only	Other		
Kentucky	UK Invests	SEC	Football only	University, nonprofit and public	Aug 1	
LSU	Woodside Energy	SEC	Department wide	Construction, energy and industry	Feb 1	
Le Moyne	ForEDU	NEC	Department wide	Technology	Sep 22	
Liberty	K-LOVE	Conference USA	Other selected sports	Media and creators	Aug 25	
Longwood	Skanska	Big South	Basketball only	Construction, energy and industry	Oct 30	
Louisiana-Monroe	Samaritan's Purse	Sun Belt	Football only	University, nonprofit and public	Feb 25	$100K
Louisville	L&N Credit Union	ACC	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance		
Loyola Chicago	Go.AI	Atlantic 10	Department wide	Technology	Oct 27	
Marshall	Marshall Health Network	Sun Belt	Department wide	Healthcare	May 1	
McNeese	Navarre Chevrolet	Southland	Department wide	Other	Jul 14	
Memphis	FedEx	American	Department wide	Transportation and logistics	Apr 10	*Unverified*
Michigan State	MSUFCU	Big Ten	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Jun 15	$4M
Missouri	Ambetter Health	SEC	Other selected sports	Healthcare		
Monmouth	BSI Corporate Benefits	CAA	Basketball only	Legal and professional services	Oct 20	
Montana	University of Montana Foundation	Big Sky	Football only	University, nonprofit and public	Aug 24	
Nevada	Renown Health	Mountain West	Basketball only	Healthcare	Oct 1	
New Mexico State	Inn of the Mountain Gods	Conference USA	Other selected sports	Tribal enterprise and gaming	Mar 1	$350K
North Dakota State	Gate City Bank	Summit / MVFC	Department wide	Finance and insurance		
Northern Illinois	AAA Roofing Contractors	Mountain West	Football only	Construction, energy and industry	Aug 26	
Notre Dame	SoFi	ACC (basketball) / Independent (football)	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Jul 1	$19M
Ohio State	JPMorganChase	Big Ten	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Jul 28	$17M
Oklahoma State	Osage Nation	Big 12	Department wide	Tribal enterprise and gaming	Jun 23	
Omaha	MCL Construction	Summit League	Basketball only	Construction, energy and industry	Jun 29	
Omaha	Hurrdat	Summit League	Other selected sports	Media and creators	Sep 17	

RIGHTS HOLDER	SPONSOR	CONFERENCE	PACKAGE	SPONSOR CATEGORY	ANNOUNCED	ANNUAL VALUE
Pacific	Dignity Health	WCC	Basketball only	Healthcare	Sep 29	
Pittsburgh	UPMC	ACC	Football only	Healthcare	Aug 27	
Providence	Santander Bank	Big East	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Sep 14	
Robert Morris	Cullen Honohan ("All Hail")	Horizon League	Basketball only	Media and creators		
SMU	Texas Capital	ACC	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Oct 13	
Saint Joseph's	Main Line Health	Atlantic 10	Department wide	Healthcare	Jul 22	
Saint Louis	World Wide Technology	Atlantic 10	Department wide	Technology	Oct 7	
Sam Houston	Snapback Sports	Conference USA	Football only	Media and creators		$100K
San Diego State	Palomar	Pac-12	Football only	Finance and insurance	Aug 31	
Siena	Broadview Federal Credit Union	Metro Conference (formerly MAAC)	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Oct 8	
South Florida	Tampa General Hospital	American	Football only	Healthcare	Apr 8	
Southeastern Louisiana	Phoenix Senior Living	Southland	Football only	Other	Sep 11	
Southern Indiana	TCG	Ohio Valley	Department wide	Transportation and logistics		$167K
Southern Miss	Forrest	Sun Belt	Football only	Healthcare	Sep 23	
St. John's	AlumniFi	Big East	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 13	
Stanford	DoorDash	ACC	Other selected sports	Transportation and logistics	Sep 25	
Stony Brook	Bulovas Restorations	CAA	Other selected sports	Legal and professional services		
Temple	Grungo Law	American	Football only	Legal and professional services	Jul 29	
Tennessee	Axle Logistics	SEC	Basketball only	Transportation and logistics	Aug 1	$3.4M
Tennessee	First Horizon Bank	SEC	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Sep 1	$12M
Texas State	CHRISTUS Health	Pac-12	Department wide	Healthcare		
Texas Tech	State Farm	Big 12	Football only	Finance and insurance	Sep 16	
Texas at Arlington	McClaren Farms	WAC	Basketball only	Food and beverage	Oct 12	
The Citadel	Palmetto State Armory	SoCon	Football only	Other	Jul 1	
Troy	Troy Bank and Trust	Sun Belt	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Aug 24	$525K
Tulane	American Safety	American	Other selected sports	Not identified	Jul 22	
UAlbany	Broadview Federal Credit Union	America East	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Oct 28	
UConn	UConn Health	Big East	Basketball only	Healthcare	Oct 2	
UConn	Aetna	Big East	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 29	
UIC	Are You Really Winning? (Illinois campaign on problem gambling)	Missouri Valley	Department wide	University, nonprofit and public	Aug 11	
UIC	UI Health	Missouri Valley	Department wide	Healthcare	Aug 11	
UMass Lowell	Workers Credit Union	America East / Hockey East	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 6	
UNLV	Acesso Biologics	Mountain West	Other selected sports	Healthcare	Dec 1, 2025	$2.2M
UTEP	GECU	Mountain West	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Aug 17	
UTEP	IBEW	Mountain West	Football only	Construction, energy and industry	Aug 31	
UTSA	La Panadería	American	Football only	Food and beverage	Jan 30	
UTSA	Las Palapas	American	Other selected sports	Food and beverage	Jul 29	

RIGHTS HOLDER	SPONSOR	CONFERENCE	PACKAGE	SPONSOR CATEGORY	ANNOUNCED	ANNUAL VALUE
UTSA	Thomas J. Henry Law	American	Other selected sports	Legal and professional services	Sep 16	$250K
Utah	University of Utah Health	Big 12	Football only	Healthcare	Sep 2	
VMI	GoH2O	SoCon	Basketball only	Not identified	Jun 26	
Vanderbilt	SRM Concrete	SEC	Department wide	Construction, energy and industry	Jul 21	
Villanova	Future Standard	Big East	Department wide	Finance and insurance	Oct 29	
WKU	Franklin Bank & Trust	Conference USA	Other selected sports	Finance and insurance	Oct 12	
Washington State	Colville Tribes	Pac-12	Department wide	Tribal enterprise and gaming	Jun 30	$1.7M
West Virginia	Antero Resources	Big 12	Department wide	Construction, energy and industry	Aug 4	*Unverified*
Western Michigan	Greenleaf Trust	MAC	Football only	Finance and insurance	Sep 4	
Wichita State	NIAR (National Institute for Aviation Research)	American	Department wide	University, nonprofit and public	Sep 24	
Wisconsin	Culver's	Big Ten	Other selected sports	Food and beverage		
Wisconsin	UW Health	Big Ten	Other selected sports	Healthcare	Apr 2	
Wisconsin-Milwaukee	Tabak Law	Horizon League	Other selected sports	Legal and professional services	Oct 6	
Wright State	Premier Health	Horizon League	Department wide	Healthcare	Oct 29	
Wyoming	Tallgrass Energy	Mountain West	Other selected sports	Construction, energy and industry	Apr 1	$900K
Xavier	1N5	Big East	Department wide	University, nonprofit and public	Sep 15	

Source: Playbook Strategies College Commercial Rights database, read October 30, 2026. Annual values are reported or annualized figures and mostly cover bundled packages; see Section 7. Blank means undisclosed. Dates are 2026 unless marked.

Appendix B: Method and data notes

Evidence terms. reported means a published figure; **bundled** means the figure covers rights beyond the patch; **patch only** means the figure covers the patch alone; **Playbook model** means a modeled estimate from the D1 Programs database; **unverified** means a figure in circulation with no original source.

Deals. The Playbook College Commercial Rights database records each announced college jersey patch partnership with its sports, sponsor, category, announcement date, rights holder, reported economics, and source. This briefing uses all 122 college patch partnerships recorded through October 30, 2026, including two Big 12 conference deals and Ferris State's Division I men's hockey team. Kentucky / UK Invests and Wichita State / NIAR are university programs on the school's own uniforms and stay in the deal count.

Package groups. Deals are grouped by the sports carrying the patch: department wide (every varsity program), football only, basketball only (men's, women's, or both, with no other sport), conference, and other selected sports (every other multisport set and single sports other than football and basketball).

Approaches. Each deal carries one scope approach from "Uniformly Different" (Whole Department, Concentrated Exposure, or Conference Scale) and any overlay that the announcement supports: Alumni and Local Alignment where the sponsor is local or regional or has an alumni or existing tie, and Product Integration where students, athletes, or the university use the sponsor's product.

Sponsor categories. Twelve groups built from the sponsor's main business. Three sponsors whose business the announcement does not identify are shown separately and kept in the total.

Prices. Source order: executed contract or public board record, then school or sponsor announcement, then original reporting, then later roundups. Annual values are the reported annual figure or the total divided by the term. A figure with no traceable original source is shown as unverified and left out of comparisons. A missing price is left blank, not counted as zero.

Model. The Playbook D1 Programs model sets a department wide patch partnership value from EADA FY2024-25 athletic revenue: mid = \$114,200 + \$1.65 million × (revenue ÷ \$100 million)$^{2.14}$, fitted on the 16 schools with a reported annual value. Above Ohio State's \$295 million in revenue, value grows in line with revenue, since no reported deal exceeds \$20 million a year. Ranges run from 85% to 120% of mid for Power Four programs and from 60% to 180% for other schools, following the spread of reported deals around the curve. Ninety one programs use extrapolated revenue, including Texas. Air Force and Army have no revenue input and no modeled value.

Sold status. A school counts as sold when it has at least one announced patch deal, whatever its scope.

Last updated: October 30, 2026. Playbook Strategies drew the figures from sources believed reliable on that date. Reported values often cover more than the patch, and modeled values are estimates with wide error; every input needs checking before a commercial decision. This document is for information and is not financial advice. Playbook Strategies is independent of the NCAA, the conferences, and the schools named, and none of them reviewed or endorsed this briefing.

Appendix C: Sources

- NCAA, Division I Cabinet approves commercial patches, January 23, 2026 *https://www.ncaa.org/news/media-center-di-cabinet-approves-commercial-patches-for-uniforms-equipment-and-apparel/*
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